

This step-by-step guide will help you prepare your dog for import into Australia from a Group 2 classified country.

You can print this guide and use it as a checklist.

Need to know

This is a complex process. Before you start the import process, we recommend you read this guide in full.

- Allow at least 6 months to complete health checks, tests and paperwork.
- All pre-export preparations and treatments must be completed by a government approved veterinarian in an approved country.
- Fees apply for our services, such as permit assessment and quarantine in Australia.
- There are certain breeds of dogs that are prohibited from import into Australia.
- Overseas travel can cause significant stress to animals. If your dog is sick or elderly, consider if this is the right decision for them.

1

We encourage you to use an experienced pet transport agent or shipper.

Importing a dog to Australia is a complex process. It will take at least 6 months to complete. You will need to make sure your dog meets a range of import conditions. This includes multiple veterinary visits, checks and treatments.

Seek help from a pet transport agent with experience in importing dogs to Australia. They will help guide you through the import process.

To find a pet transport agent or shipper you can:

- search online (use terms like ‘pet transport agent Australia’)
- check industry associations or member directories such as:

We cannot recommend one agent over another. We have no influence over any fees or charges an agent may require for their services.

2

You must meet all import conditions before you can bring your dog to Australia.

Check if this is the right guide for you

This step-by-step guide is for dogs exported from Group 2 countries. These are approved countries of origin for dog imports into Australia.

Check the list of Group 2 countries to make sure this is the right guide for you.

- American Samoa
- Bahrain
- Barbados
- Christmas Island
- Cook Island
- Falkland Islands
- Federated States of Micronesia
- Fiji
- French Polynesia
- Guam
- Hawaii
- Iceland
- Japan
- Kiribati Mauritius
- Nauru
- New Caledonia
- Niue
- Palau
- Papua New Guinea
- Samoa
- Singapore
- Solomon Islands
- Kingdom of Tonga
- Tuvalu
- Vanuatu
- Wallis & Futuna

Your country of export is not on the Group 2 list. [Find the right step-by-step guide](#) for your animal and country of export.

If your dog is coming from a Group 2 country, continue through this guide.

Confirm your dog is eligible for import to Australia

To be eligible for import to Australia, your dog must have either:

- lived in a Group 1 or Group 2 approved country since birth, or
- lived in a Group 1 or Group 2 approved country since it was exported directly from Australia, or
- lived in a Group 1 or Group 2 approved country for at least 180 days since its official identity check and immediately before the proposed date of export.

You must also meet:

- all requirements outlined in this guide
- all import conditions on your dog's unique import permit

You can apply for an import permit when you reach step 4.1 of this guide.

The 180 days in an approved country is NOT a quarantine period.

Your dog can be living with you or someone else in a Group 1 or Group 2 approved country while being prepared for export. They must undergo a period of quarantine after arriving in Australia.

When you plan to export your dog, it must NOT be:

- under quarantine restrictions
- more than 30 days pregnant
- nursing puppies

Some dog breeds are not allowed into Australia.

This includes some hybrid dogs (domestic and non-domestic) and some pure-bred dogs.

These bans relate to environmental protection and customs laws. They are not biosecurity laws. You will need to talk to the relevant government agency for details.

[Hybrid](#) dogs NOT allowed into Australia include, but are not limited to, these breeds and any crossbreed offspring from them:

- Czechoslovakian wolfdog or Czechoslovakian Vlcak
- Saarloos wolfdog or Saarloos wolfhound
- Lupo Italiano or Italian wolfdog
- Kunming wolfdog or Kunming dog

Contact the Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water (DCCEEW) at exotic.species@dcceew.gov.au. They can provide more advice on hybrid animals.

Pure breed dogs banned from Australia include:

- Dogo Argentino
- Fila Brasileiro
- Japanese Tosa
- American Pit Bull Terrier or Pit Bull Terrier
- Perro de Presa Canario or Presa Canario.

Mixed-breed dogs are allowed if the dog meets all other import conditions. Visit [Australian Border Force](#) for more advice on prohibited dog breeds.

If your dog is sick or old

Consider your dog's age and general health.

Sick and elderly animals, and those with chronic diseases may not cope with long distance travel and climatic stress.

We do not recommend importing sick or very old animals. International travel can cause them to destabilise and rapidly deteriorate. Even dogs with well-managed chronic diseases can arrive in distress and poor health.

An import permit will not be refused based on an animal's age. Consider your dog's age and how they may handle the journey and quarantine in Australia. Seek advice from your veterinarian if you're concerned.

Dogs with special care requirements

There may be conditions that we cannot manage during the post entry quarantine period, or medications that we cannot administer. See [Cats and dogs travelling to Australia with special care requirements](#).

Animals may be unable to get medication during transport. As a pet owner, you must consider if it's in your pet's best interests to travel the long distance and stay in quarantine.

Seek advice from the competent authority in your country of export

Each approved country has its own endorsement process and specific documents.

You must contact the competent authority in your exporting country. They will confirm if you are using the most up-to-date, country-specific documents.

Find the competent authority in your country

A [competent authority](#) is the government agency responsible for animal health. This may be a [government veterinary service](#) or similar. In Australia, it is us (Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry).

The competent authority must provide official documents for your dog before it leaves for Australia.

We check these documents when your dog arrives in Australia to ensure your dog has met all pre-export requirements.

Find an authorised veterinarian to prepare your dog for export

All pre-export veterinary procedures must be:

- completed in the country of export
- completed by a [government approved veterinarian](#)

- endorsed by an [official government veterinarian](#)
- completed before departing for Australia

This process ensures your dog doesn't bring pests or diseases to Australia.

When you talk to the competent authority in your exporting country, they will let you know:

- which documents or forms you must use
- any local procedures or requirements you must meet before you export your dog
- how to find a government approved veterinarian to prepare your dog for export to Australia
- how to find government approved laboratories for pre-export testing

We rely on the competent authority to identify which veterinarians can prepare dogs for export in their jurisdiction. In many countries, this may simply be a registered veterinarian. In some countries, it may be specific veterinarians.

Don't risk arriving in Australia with the wrong checks, treatments or certificates.

Talk to the competent authority. Only use a government approved veterinarian to prepare your dog for export.

Read through this guide

We recommend you read this whole guide before you start the import process.

This guide details important actions you must take. This includes applying for and being issued with an import permit. Your import permit outlines the preparations required for your dog. You must meet all these conditions before you bring your dog to Australia.

Share this guide and your import permit with your:

- government approved veterinarian
- pet transport company

They will help you meet all import conditions.

3

Do this before you start the import process and at least 180 days before you wish to export your dog.

Check your dog has a microchip or implant a new one

Microchips are the only approved identification method. The competent authority in the country of export will use the microchip to verify your dog's identity.

Your dog must have a working microchip before you start the import process.

If a microchip cannot be read or is incorrect in your documents, your dog cannot be imported to Australia.

A [government approved veterinarian](#) must scan the microchip:

- at each veterinary visit
- before any pre-export blood sampling.

They must ensure that the microchip number is accurately recorded on all documentation, including test samples. This is how we match your dog to its preparations and documents.

Your dog must be implanted with a microchip that can be read by an ISO compatible microchip reader. Generally, microchips with 10 or 15 digits are ISO compliant.

Microchip numbers starting with 999 are not accepted because they are not unique. AVID microchips that are 9 digits long are not acceptable because they are not ISO compatible.

We do not accept laboratory reports or other documents where the microchip details have been amended.

This includes changes to microchip number as well as the collection date, laboratory received date, or results.

If your dog has 2 compliant microchips

Both compliant microchip numbers must be included on:

- the identity check
- the import permit application
- the final import permit
- all laboratory reports
- the veterinary health certificate.

Both microchips must be scanned and recorded at each veterinary visit. They must match all import documents.

If your dog has a compliant microchip and a non-compliant microchip, we will only use the compliant microchip.

If your dog's microchip stops working

The veterinarian should try multiple microchip scanners to read the microchip.

If the microchip cannot be read, a new ISO compatible microchip must be implanted. Then the pre-export process must begin again. This includes all tests, treatments, examinations, and the official identity verification.

Your dog must arrive in Australia with a compliant microchip. It must be scannable and linked to the import permit, health certificate and laboratory reports.

If the microchip cannot be scanned, or if the microchip number is inconsistent on any import paperwork, your dog will be exported from Australia.

Verify your dog's identity

Your dog's identity must be verified by the competent authority in the export country.

This step is required to import your dog to Australia. You must complete this step before starting any other pre-export preparations.

An [official government veterinarian](#) must:

- verify your dog's identity
- complete the identity declaration form
- send the form directly to us

Each approved country has its own country-specific forms and processes. You must contact the competent authority in your country of export for guidance.

Pet passports, vaccination cards, or microchip certificates are not accepted as equivalent documents.

Identity declarations do not expire.

Once received and accepted by us, they remain valid for as long as the microchip is functional and your animal:

- can be identified by the verified microchip on the declaration, and
- resided in a Group 1 or Group 2 approved country.

All dogs must have their identity verified before you start the import process, including dogs under 6 months of age.

If this is done and a permit is lodged before the dog turns 6 months old, the 180-day waiting period before export may not apply.

Returning Australian animals

If your dog is returning to Australia directly from the country they were exported to, their health certificate may be used to verify their identity. We must have issued this certificate before your dog departed Australia.

Your dog's microchip must remain valid and be able to be scanned. The microchip must be recorded for every test, treatment and examination. This includes scans on arrival into our quarantine facility.

See more on [returning Australian animals](#).

If you no longer have a copy of the health certificate:

Contact the [regional office](#) your dog was exported from and request a copy. If you're unable to obtain the records, contact us at imports@aff.gov.au.

4

Allow plenty of time to get your permit before your proposed export date.

Apply for a permit as soon as you intend to travel.

Permits can take time to be issued. Most permits are issued in 20-40 business days. It can take up to 123 business days in some cases.

Apply for an import permit

Apply for your import permit through our [Biosecurity Import Conditions System](#) (BICON).

Be aware that applying for an import permit does not guarantee you will be issued with one.

We cannot expedite an application for any reason. We understand this may be difficult. To ensure fairness to all applicants, we process permits in the order they are received.

Import permits are valid for 12 months from the date the permit is granted.

See more on [how to apply for an import permit](#).

Assistance dogs

Assistance dogs must meet all import conditions to come to Australia.

If you want to import an assistance dog, you will need to submit extra forms to us. Do this through BICON as part of your import permit application.

See more on [importing an assistance dog](#).

Pay in full when you submit your application in BICON.

Import permit applications are not processed until fees are paid in full. Extra charges may apply if information is missing, incorrect, or if an application is put on hold.

Your import permit is NOT issued.

We may require more details from you before we can issue a permit. We'll advise you of action you can take to meet import conditions. In rare cases, we may refuse to issue an import permit.

Once your import permit is issued..

Continue through the steps in this guide.

Meet all import permit conditions

Read your import permit carefully. It includes important conditions you must meet.

Once you are granted an import permit, you must make sure you meet all your import permit conditions.

The conditions will be specified on the permit. This includes specific pre-export veterinary procedures required for your dog. These conditions are mandatory.

Make sure you read all import permit conditions and understand what you need to do.

If you fail to comply with your permit conditions, your dog may be:

- held longer in post entry quarantine
- subject to additional testing and treatment
- exported
- euthanised.

You will also be liable for any costs involved.

Import permits are valid for up to 12 months from date of issue.

The permit must be valid at the time of export to Australia.

As your dog is coming from a group 2 country, entry is only permitted 180 days after verification of identity (see Step 3.2).

5

Do this after you receive your import permit.

Book your dog's post-entry quarantine stay

Your dog will stay at least 10 days in quarantine in Australia.

Dogs must spend at least 10 days at the Mickleham post entry quarantine facility. Our quarantine facility is designed to comfortably accommodate dogs and meet their needs.

Check rules for stops on the way to Australia

We have specific rules for travel that include stops in other countries.

These rules depend on whether your dog will:

- remain on the plane (transiting)
- be unloaded from the plane and moved to another plane (transshipping).

Make sure you understand these rules when choosing flights.

Transiting

During transport to Australia, dogs may transit in all countries. This means the plane can touch down in a country, but your dog must stay on the plane on the international side of the airport.

Transshipping

Your dog may only tranship (change aircraft) in:

- an [approved Group 1 or Group 2 country](#), OR
- these cities in Group 3 countries:
 - Amsterdam
 - Frankfurt
 - Copenhagen
 - London
 - Dubai
 - Hong Kong.

Your dog must not leave the international side of the airport. It must stay under the supervision of the [competent authority](#) in the country of transshipment. It must be in a place that restricts contact with other animals.

It is your responsibility as the importer to contact the competent authority in the country of transshipment. You need to find out:

- whether they allow animals to tranship
- whether they have a facility to hold animals during transshipment
- how long the animals can be held
- if additional conditions apply.

Your dog may not be eligible for import if these conditions are not met.

Consider your dog's travel arrangements

We cannot control how long your dog will be held at these destinations. If your dog is sick or elderly, consider if this is the right decision for them.

Book travel for your dog

You can either make the travel arrangements yourself or use an animal transport company.

You can use any airline to transport your dog to Australia, at the airline operator's discretion. See the International Pet and Animal Transportation Association website for a list of [animal transport companies](#).

Your dog must arrive directly into Melbourne International airport from your country of export. We do not permit domestic transfers.

If you cannot get a direct flight into Melbourne International airport, contact us at imports@aff.gov.au.

Travelling as manifested cargo

Your dog must travel:

- as manifested cargo (not in the cabin)
- in a crate that meets the [International Air Transport Association \(IATA\) guidelines](#), including being the appropriate size for your dog.

We are not responsible for your dog while they are under the care of the aircraft operator.

Travelling via private or chartered flight

Find out more if you plan to [import your dog via private or chartered flight](#).

You must pay for all transport costs for your dog.

6

These must be completed by a government approved veterinarian in the country of export.

Plan early. You need to make sure you complete all treatments and tests in the correct timeframes before export.

Check all timings of tests and treatments as soon as possible.

All preparations are calculated from the [date of export](#). When calculating timeframes, the day your dog receives a treatment or preparation counts as 'day 0'. Timeframes are counted in calendar days.

We do not accept laboratory reports or other documents where the details have been amended.

This includes changes to microchip number as well as the collection date, laboratory received date, or results.

Contact us at imports@aff.gov.au if you identify a mistake on any of your dog's laboratory reports.

Complete all remaining veterinary preparations

All veterinary preparations must be done by a [government approved veterinarian](#) in the country of export.

Your dog must be fit and healthy enough to:

- travel to Australia

- undergo post-entry quarantine without ongoing veterinary intervention

Female dogs must not be more than 30 days pregnant at the time of export.

We are not responsible for the veterinary and husbandry care requirements for heavily pregnant or post-partum dogs, or puppies.

All testing must be done by a laboratory approved by the [competent authority](#) in the country of export.

To find a government approved veterinarian or [laboratory](#), contact the [competent authority](#) in the country of export.

We cannot give advice on treatments for diseases.

Seek advice from a government approved veterinarian if your dog tests positive to an infectious disease listed in the import conditions.

Some South Pacific Island countries may not have a permanent government approved veterinarian. Contact us if you do not have a local government approved veterinarian. Do this well ahead of your planned date of export. In some cases, veterinary preparations can be completed by a visiting foreign veterinarian.

We recommend you share this step-by-step guide and your import permit with your government approved veterinarian.

Your government approved veterinarian will help make sure you meet all import conditions. This information is also useful to share with pet transport companies.

Download guidance for veterinarians

- [Guidance for government approved veterinarians preparing dogs and cats for export to Australia \(PDF 295 KB\)](#)
- [Guidance for government approved veterinarians preparing dogs and cats for export to Australia \(DOCX 120 KB\)](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, [contact us](#) for help.

Understand vaccination requirements

Some vaccination requirements depend on the country of export. Any required vaccinations are explained later in this guide.

Vaccination requirements and recommendations

Different vaccines have different timing requirements. Always follow the vaccine manufacturer's instructions and speak to your government approved veterinarian if you are unsure.

Calculating vaccination intervals

To calculate a vaccination interval, the first date of treatment is counted as day 0. For example, if a vaccination is given on 1 January (day 0) and the vaccination interval is 21 days, the booster vaccination should be given on 22 January (day 21).

Recommended vaccinations

We also recommend your dog is vaccinated against:

- Distemper
- Hepatitis
- Parvovirus
- Parainfluenza
- Bordetella bronchiseptica

These vaccinations are not required to import your dog to Australia.

These diseases are already present in Australia and are not considered a biosecurity risk. However, keeping your dog's vaccinations up to date may help protect their health during travel and quarantine.

Meet the *Leptospira canicola* (leptospirosis) requirement

All dogs coming to Australia from a Group 2 country must meet the leptospirosis requirement.

Your dog must meet one of the following options:

Option 1: Vaccination pathway

Allow enough time to complete the primary course following the registered manufacturer's directions

For previously unvaccinated dogs, the primary course must be completed at least 14 days before export to Australia.

For dogs with a history of regular vaccinations, the annual booster vaccination must be administered between 12 months and 14 days before export to Australia.

If you chose to vaccinate, your dog must be fully vaccinated against *Leptospira interrogans* serovar Canicola.

This is:

- a [primary vaccination](#) course of 2 vaccines given at the interval recommended by the manufacturer, usually 2-4 weeks apart
- ongoing booster vaccinations given yearly, or at the interval recommended by the manufacturer, to maintain immunity.

The vaccination must:

- be administered in accordance with the manufacturer's recommendations.

- be registered for use in dogs in the country of export
- be valid at the time of export.

If the manufacturer specifies that the primary course injections must be 3 weeks apart, there must be 21 days between doses.

Manufacturers recommendations can differ between products and countries. Contact the official government veterinarian in the country of export for advice on vaccination intervals.

Download *Leptospira* vaccination guidance for veterinarians

- [Leptospira interrogans sv. Canicola vaccination guidance for veterinarians preparing dogs for export to Australia \(PDF 338 KB\)](#)
- [Leptospira interrogans sv. Canicola vaccination guidance for veterinarians preparing dogs for export to Australia \(DOCX 228 KB\)](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, [contact us](#) for help.

The leptospirosis vaccination available in Australia does NOT provide protection against the strain *Leptospira interrogans* serovar Canicola.

For import into Australia the vaccination administered must protect against *Leptospira interrogans* serovar Canicola. Leptospirosis vaccination administered in Australia is not considered compliant for import into Australia.

Option 2: Test for *Leptospira canicola* (leptospirosis)

Test for *Leptospira interrogans* serovar Canicola within 45 days of the date of export.

If your dog is not vaccinated against *Leptospira interrogans* serovar Canicola, it may meet the requirement through testing.

A government approved veterinarian must:

- scan and verify your dog's microchip
- collect and test a blood sample using a microscopic agglutination test (MAT).

The MAT test must be completed within 45 days of export.

The test must produce a negative result.

Important information about choosing a pathway

Choose one pathway only – vaccination or testing.

Dogs that are vaccinated, or in the process of being vaccinated, should not be tested using the MAT pathway.

If your dog receives a positive MAT result:

- it cannot switch to the vaccination pathway to meet import requirements
- vaccination does not override a positive MAT result
- you must contact the department for advice.

Further investigations, treatment requirements, or delays to export may apply.

A dog with a positive *Leptospira interrogans* serovar Canicola MAT result is NOT eligible for import to Australia.

Contact imports@aff.gov.au to discuss your specific case. Include your import permit number, full vaccination history and laboratory report in the email.

Vaccinate for Canine influenza virus (Singapore and Hawaii only)

Dogs from Singapore and Hawaii must be fully vaccinated against the circulating strain of canine influenza virus (CIV).

This is:

- a primary vaccination course of 2 vaccines given at the interval recommended by the manufacturer, usually 2-4 weeks apart
- ongoing booster vaccinations given yearly, or at the interval recommended by the manufacturer, to maintain immunity.

Dogs without a compliant primary vaccination course, are not fully vaccinated.

The vaccination must be administered in accordance with the manufacturer's recommendations. The vaccination must be valid at the time of export and registered for use in dogs in the country of export.

Make sure your government approved veterinarian uses a CIV vaccine that is effective against the CIV virus strain(s) in the area where your dog has been living.

If unsure, contact the competent authority in the country of export for guidance.

Allow enough time to complete the primary course following the registered manufacturer's directions.

For previously unvaccinated dogs, the primary course must be completed at least 14 days before export to Australia.

For dogs with a history of regular CIV vaccinations, the annual booster vaccination must be given between 12 months and 14 days before export to Australia.

Test for *Brucella canis* (brucellosis)

To be considered desexed:

- female dogs must have undergone ovariectomy or bilateral ovariectomy

- male dogs must have undergone bilateral orchiectomy.

Evidence of desexing may be requested by the competent authority in the country of export. We may also request evidence.

If your dog is not desexed, you must:

- stop mating or artificially inseminating your dog within specific timeframes,
- have your dog's blood collected by a government approved veterinarian for testing.

To meet these timings, you must:

- stop mating or artificially inseminating the dog at least 21 days before you intend to get the dogs blood sample collected
- take your dog to a government approved veterinarian
- request a government approved veterinarian scan and record your dog's microchip number
- request a government approved veterinarian collect the blood sample for *Brucella canis* within 45 days of export
- do not mate or inseminate the dog again after the test sample is collected until export to Australia.

The blood sample must be tested using one of these methods:

- a rapid slide agglutination test (RSAT), or
- a tube agglutination test (TAT), or
- an indirect fluorescent antibody test (IFAT).

The test must produce a negative result.

Ensure you use the correct test type

Only the standard versions of these tests will be accepted. Some laboratories refer to the TAT as a serum agglutination test. This test type is also accepted.

A dog with a positive *Brucella canis* test is NOT eligible for import to Australia.

Contact us at imports@aff.gov.au to discuss your specific case. Include your import permit number and a copy of your laboratory report in the email.

Test for *Leishmania infantum* (Canine leishmaniasis)

Test for *Leishmania infantum* (Canine leishmaniasis) within 45 days of the date of export.

A government approved veterinarian must scan and verify your dog's microchip. They must collect and test a blood sample using one of these methods:

- an indirect fluorescent antibody test (IFAT)
- an enzyme linked immunosorbent assay (ELISA)

The test must produce a negative result.

Ensure you use the correct test type

Only the standard, quantitative versions of the above tests from an approved laboratory will be accepted. 'Rapid' or 'snap' versions of these tests are not acceptable.

A dog with a positive *Leishmania infantum* blood result is NOT eligible for import to Australia.

Contact us at imports@aff.gov.au to discuss your specific case. Include your import permit number and a copy of your laboratory report in the email.

Treat for external parasites

Start at least 30 days before export and repeat according to manufacturer directions.

To calculate 30 days before the date of export, count the first day the treatment as day 0. For example, if treatment is given 1 January, then the earliest date of export is 31 January.

A government approved veterinarian must treat your dog with an acceptable product that kills ticks and fleas on contact. The chosen product must remain effective against new flea and tick infestations until the date of export to Australia.

The government approved veterinarian may need to repeat the treatment to maintain continuous protection until export. They must follow the manufacturer's directions. Reapplication periods for fleas and ticks (or species of tick) may differ. If so, adhere to the shortest reapplication interval.

At each step of the export preparation the government approved veterinarian must:

- scan the dog's microchip
- examine the dog for signs of external parasites.

If fleas or ticks are found they must be removed, and the preparation must be restarted.

See [acceptable external parasite treatments](#).

Treatments must be administered and recorded by a government approved veterinarian.

Treat for internal parasites

Plan enough time to complete treatments before export.

Your dog must be treated twice within 45 days before export. The two treatments must be spaced at least 14 days apart. The second treatment must be given within 5 days before the date of export.

For example, if the date of export is 30 January:

- The earliest date the first treatment can be given is 16 December.
- The earliest date the second treatment can be given is 25 January.

- There are more than 14 days between 16 December and 25 January – this meets the 14-day spacing requirement.

A government approved veterinarian must treat your dog for nematodes and cestodes (internal parasites).

See [acceptable internal parasite treatments](#).

Treatments must be administered and recorded by a government approved veterinarian.

Combined products that cover both nematodes and cestodes are available in many countries and are accepted for use.

Treat for *Babesia canis rossi* if your dog has ever visited mainland Africa

If your dog has ever visited mainland Africa, a government approved veterinarian must treat your dog internally with imidocarb dipropionate.

Dosages are either:

- a single dose at 7.5 mg/kg body weight, or
- 2 doses at 6.0 mg/kg body weight given 14 days apart.

Treatments must be given by subcutaneous injection.

7

These are the final preparation activities before you export your dog.

Book a final pre-export clinical examination

Within 5 days before your dog's date of export.

When calculating timeframes, the day the treatment or preparation is completed counts as 'day 0'. For example, if your dog's [date of export](#) is 30 January, the final veterinary health check can be completed on or after 25 January.

Your dog must be examined for external parasites and clinical signs of infectious or contagious disease. This must be done within 5 days of export by a [government approved veterinarian](#) or an [official government veterinarian](#).

You will need these documents for the final examination:

- a valid import permit
- evidence of desexing (if desexed)
- *Brucella canis* laboratory report (if not desexed)
- *Leishmania infantum* laboratory report
- *Leptospira interrogans* serovar *Canicola* laboratory report or vaccination certificate

- Canine influenza virus vaccination certificate (if required)
- evidence of external parasite treatments
- evidence of internal parasite treatments
- evidence of Babesia canis rossi treatment (if required)
- the veterinary health certificate, if required by your competent authority.

Get your veterinary health certificate

The veterinary health certificate is specific to your country of export. Different countries may use different certificates and processes.

You must get the veterinary health certificate required for export to Australia from the competent authority in your country of export. The competent authority can provide the certificate and advice on how it must be completed. DAFF does not issue or provide veterinary health certificates.

Depending on the requirements in your country of export, the certificate may be completed by a government approved veterinarian, an official government veterinarian, or both. The competent authority can tell you who must complete the certificate.

This may be done during the final pre-export clinical examination (see Step 7.1).

Get your documents endorsed by an official government veterinarian

For example, if the date of export is 30 January, the earliest date the health certificate can be endorsed is 25 January. The certificate must be endorsed after the final veterinary health check and the second internal parasite treatment have been completed. They can both be completed on the same day.

The completed veterinary health certificate and laboratory test reports must be endorsed by an official government veterinarian from the competent authority.

An official government veterinarian must:

- endorse every page of the veterinary health certificate
- give you a seal to be placed on your dog's crate at the time of export
- record the seal number on the veterinary health certificate.

An official government veterinarian must also endorse every page of the:

- Leishmania infantum laboratory report
- Brucella canis laboratory report (if not desexed)
- Leptospira interrogans serovar Canicola laboratory report (if not vaccinated).

Endorsement of the import permit is not required.

Corrections

Corrections to the veterinary health certificate must be struck through. Corrections must be legible and must be signed, stamped, and dated by the official government veterinarian.

It will result in the documents being rejected upon arrival in Australia.

Government offices may be closed over local public holidays and weekends. Make sure that you have enough time to get the veterinary health certificate endorsed before export.

Gather your import documents

Your dog must arrive in Australia with these documents:

- a valid import permit
- a veterinary health certificate
- all laboratory test reports required for import.

The veterinary health certificate and any required laboratory test reports must include evidence that they have been issued, approved or endorsed by an official government veterinarian of the competent authority. This may be shown through an official stamp, seal, signature or secure digital endorsement.

A valid import permit, veterinary health certificate and relevant documents must travel to Australia with your dog. Keep a copy of each document for your records.

8

What to do when you're ready to send your dog, and what will happen when they arrive.

Prepare your dog for travel

On the day of travel:

- place your dog in a crate that meets the [IATA standard recommended container requirements](#) that is appropriate for the size of your dog, including any bedding or other comfort requirements.
- don't place any items, including toys, medication or items of value in the crate (these will be destroyed as biosecurity waste upon arrival)
- seal your dog into the crate using the seal supplied by the official government veterinarian.

In most cases, you will check your dog in at the freight terminal, not the passenger terminal.

Check with your airline to find out which terminal you need to use.

This is due to the potential for adverse effects during transport. Most airlines follow IATA guidelines and do not permit sedation. If you are concerned about your dog's wellbeing during travel, seek advice from your veterinarian. If sedation is being considered, please confirm with your airline whether it is allowed.

What may happen during travel

You can find general information on the [IATA website](#), or the website of your chosen airline.

Your dog's crate must remain sealed. The seal must be intact on arrival in Australia.

Your dog's crate may only be opened in exceptional circumstances. Opening the crate will cause the tamper-evident seal to be broken.

If this occurs, the crate must be resealed by:

- an official government veterinarian, or
- airport authority, or
- the captain of the aircraft.

They must also provide a certificate detailing the circumstances. The certificate should be attached to the outside of the crate before departure from the port where the seal was broken.

When your dog arrives in Australia

One of our biosecurity officers will collect your dog on arrival. They will transport your dog directly to the Mickleham post entry quarantine facility.

You will be notified via email that your dog has arrived safely, within 24 hours of arrival. We will contact you immediately if there is an issue with your dog on arrival.

We will:

- help your dog settle in and get comfortable after their flight
- check your dog to make sure they're healthy and free from diseases or pests of biosecurity concern
- assess your dog's import documents to check they comply with our import conditions.

Your dog will be housed in a large, individual, climate-controlled enclosure. They'll be fed quality food, groomed, and provided with enrichment. We will send you updates on your dog's health and wellbeing.

If your dog does not comply with the permit conditions, further tests, treatments or quarantine may apply.

Dogs must stay at Mickleham for a minimum of 10 days.

Any issues that increase biosecurity risk such as incomplete documentation or using unacceptable treatments may result in a longer stay.

Read more about our state-of-the-art [quarantine facilities](#).

Register your dog in Australia

You are responsible for meeting local requirements for dogs in Australia. We recommend that you register your dog with a national microchip registry.

Contact your local Australian council or state or territory government for advice on:

- registering your dog
- microchipping
- yearly fees
- desexing requirements
- other legal requirements

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/cats-dogs/how-to-import/step-by-step-guides/category-2-step-by-step-guide-for-dogs>